



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05785) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **58**

Responses Received: **57**

Response Ratio: **98.3 %**

Subject Details

merged_subject_id

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Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, January 26, 2026**

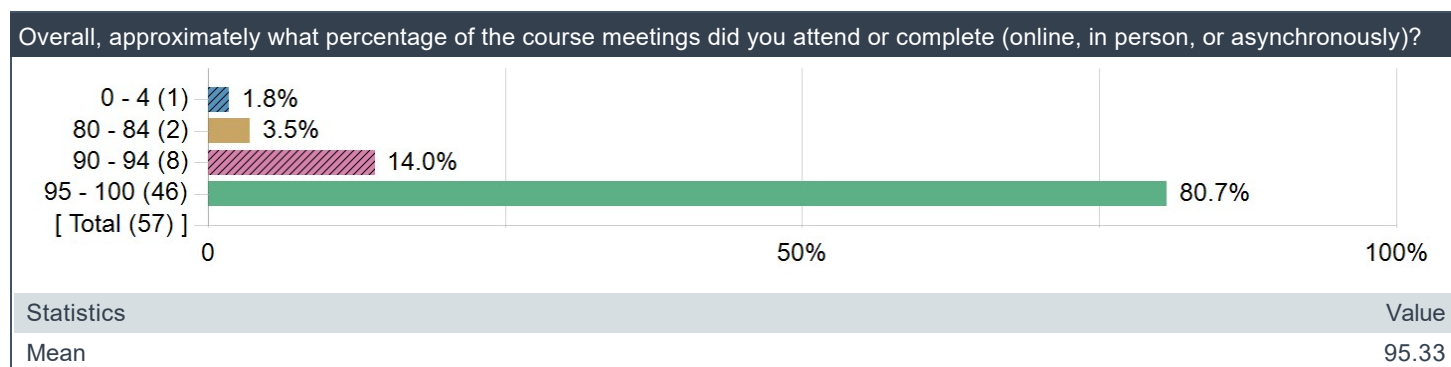
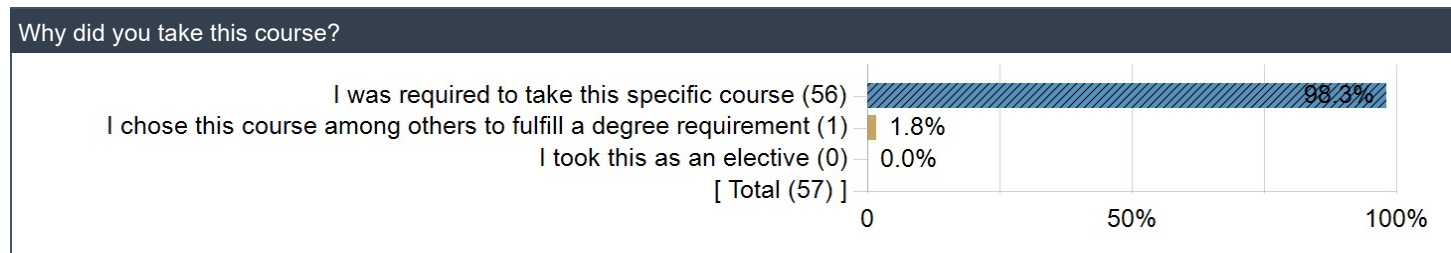
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	43.9%	36.8%	17.5%	1.8%	0.0%	57	4.23
The course was well organized.	42.1%	36.8%	17.5%	1.8%	1.8%	57	4.16
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	54.4%	33.3%	10.5%	1.8%	0.0%	57	4.40
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	54.4%	35.1%	8.8%	1.8%	0.0%	57	4.42
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	49.1%	36.8%	12.3%	1.8%	0.0%	57	4.33
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	45.6%	33.3%	10.5%	5.3%	5.3%	57	4.09
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	52.6%	35.1%	12.3%	0.0%	0.0%	57	4.40

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	45.6%	36.8%	15.8%	1.8%	0.0%	57	4.26
Overall, this course was	40.4%	31.6%	22.8%	1.8%	3.5%	57	4.04

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comment
The review sessions
The course was well taught and had plenty of hands-on practice
the multi attempt homeworks and working through code first in class
knowledge checks
Aspects that were most effective in helping my learning were that Professor Bolfarine encouraged collaboration.
Dr. Bolfarine is very good at explaining complex subjects, so attending his lectures, where he encouraged asking questions, allowed me to gain a deeper knowledge about statistics. His open-door policy with office hours was also very helpful.
lots of practice throughout the units
The review sessions and the links to the r scripts.
I appreciated having big review sessions before the tests and many different practice tests to help study.
Professor Bolfarine's ability to break down statistical ideas and connect them to real data science applications was extremely effective for my learning. The in-class coding examples and structured practice reinforced each concept in a practical way.
Having recorded class lectures to review after class. Also, the lab recording to review the code.
Looking over the weekly zoom video to go over the content. Additionally, watching the videos that the TA's provided for each subject.
Very helpful professor who wants his students to learn.
I found the practice materials for the exams the most helpful, second to attending lecture itself of course.
I liked the collaborative quizzes a lot as they helped me learn from others.
All the slides were available online as long as recordings of the lectures. Also the TAs were really helpful with all of the review content provided. Enjoyed how we were able to work on in class assignments together and questions were always welcome; both of these factors helped me understand content.
The instructor was very good at explaining concepts and often made the students laugh, group and collaborative quizzes were super helpful in order to bounce off ideas and understand through other peoples thinking.
Visuals.
I liked the homework assignments. They allowed me to flex my muscles, though I think we could've done with even more.
The collaborative quizzes helped me learn the concepts and discuss with others what I struggled with.
I liked the lectures and examples we covered during class.
In-class walkthroughs of the code and concepts we were using.
Well organized class
I found Professor Bolfarine's teaching style very organized and straight-forward which I really liked. I also appreciated the frequent questions he would ask in class and hands-on work we would do in R-Studio.
Recordings
I thought this class perfectly aligned with my learning style. I loved we were given an intro to the topic in the class slides, followed by an r studio walk through to tie everything together. I also appreciated being able to rewatch lectures and labs when I needed to. I thought the daily quizzes were a great way to test my readiness for the exams.
slides were good
In-class quizzes that keep me up. Great lectures.
Walkthrough of R code during class and unlimited attempts for homeworks
The complementary sessions with the slides information were really good as they expanded the content explained.
Homeworks and Pre class quizzes
Practicing in class and working with others
I thought that the lectures were helpful and interesting. The homework assignments were mostly helpful as well.
I found the lecture recordings and labs helpful. Even though I was in an in-person section, I would rewatch the online class recordings (zoom class) because they were more conceptual than the in-person classes because there was not a lot of coding in them. I found access to these resources on canvas very useful.
The walk throughs in R studio during class.
The TA office hours were insightful and the resources were well organized on Canvas.

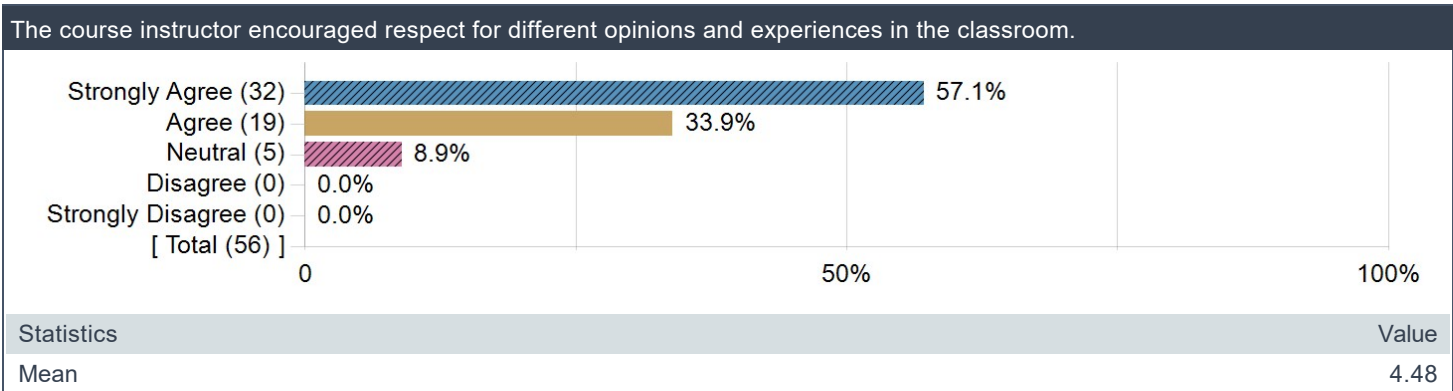
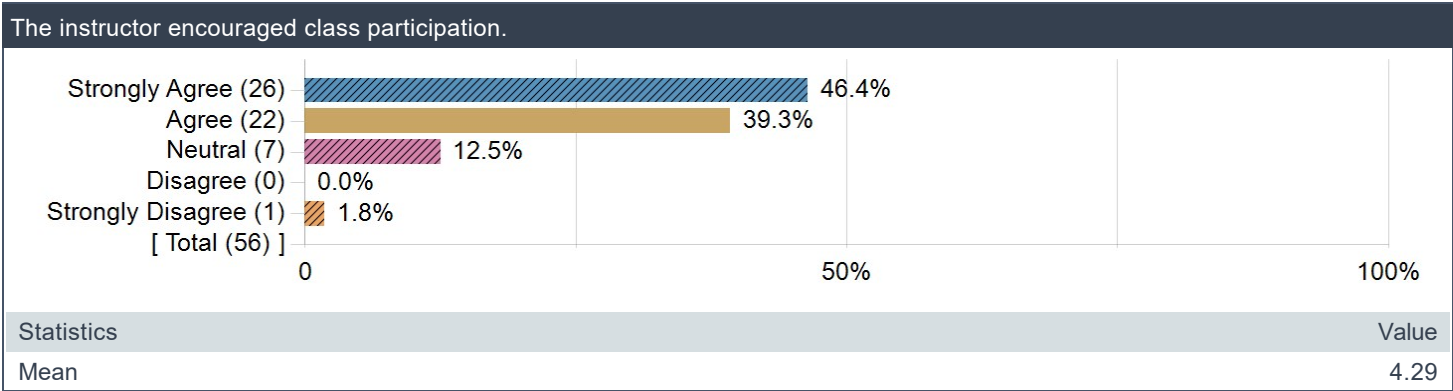
Comment
the slides
The professor was incredible and so helpful in teaching and breaking down the steps.
very good professor
What helped me learn the most were the Lab recordings.
He was interactive with the class and the quizzes made sure I knew what I needed to know before every class.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comment
The classes
The professor oftentimes kept us late, and the homework, in-class quiz, and post-class quiz were not necessary ALL necessary
not better organizing the separate formulas for the R script, and i wouldve learned better breaking up the lessons into smaller topics throughout each class.
tests
It was most challenging to learn the material and apply it to the midterm exams. Coding can be new to some and we do more learning of new material than we do of practice, which is what the entirety of the course is built upon (practice).
The two-hour block of this class makes focusing a little difficult. With the complexity of the material, it makes me wish this was a 3 credit course to accommodate two 90-minute weekly lectures rather than one 120-minute lecture.
wish there was code for the homeworks as keys posted
I would often not feel prepared for the homework and it was the most challenging part of the class.
The incorrect quiz/class participation quizzes could be adjusted more quickly.
The most challenging aspect of the course was keeping up with some of the more advanced statistical concepts when they were introduced quickly, which made it difficult to fully grasp the intuition behind them before applying them in code. Future students might benefit from short concept recap sessions or additional example walkthroughs before moving to the next topic, so they have more time to solidify their understanding.
The most challenging part is the beginning of class quizzes. It would be helpful if we reviewed the quizzes after we took them.
The aspect that I found most challenging were the Homeworks because I had class Monday, so it was difficult to recall the content till Sunday. I think one thing I would suggest would be to make the assignments or the class close together so that it would easier to recall.
R studio is an outdated program which I personally find very mediocre and should no longer be used. Maybe updating the class and implementing newer data science programs.
I found the homework assignments the most challenging, ust because I felt like they were a lot more coding heavy than what we did in class. I like this though, because it made the midterm seem easier.
I found the exams and practice questions to be very tough because I feel that we are not adequately taught how to approach them.
Sometimes it was not super clear what all the functions we are using in R are individually doing, we would be taught how to solve problems in class and use those code blocks again for other assignments instead of comprehending what each code line did individually.
Decision Trees, a Stats 235 SI canvas page with review content and simplified explanations would have been a big turning point in helping us students undertnand.
Too much content in one day.
I found the pre-class quizzes challenging. It felt as though the prior work we had didn't fully stretch our muscles and it was hard to ever feel fully prepared for these quizzes due to lack of practice.
The most challenging part was the homeworks but the professor is super helpful during office hours.
I found the coding aspect challenging, however this was met appropriately with plenty of oppurtunities to seek help.
The most challenging aspect of the course had to do with its continuity. It felt like if I missed even one day of class then I was behind by a lot. The professor could continue to use cumulative learning checkpoints throughout the class to help with this.
It is a hard class
There was nothing more that could have been provided for me in order to help me with the course.
Subject matter. It is very hard to understand
This class had some topics I had never seen before, which made it a little difficult but necessary. I thought all of the material and

Comment
work I did was meaningful, but I would have been interested in working on some type of fun project to apply what I've been learning. It could be a great way to help students earn an extra grade while solidifying some of the concepts we cover.
R and RStudio are unintuitive and don't seem very applicable to the majority of business majors
N/A
N/A
I found difficulty in learning many rstudio models at a fast pace because there are so many variations and it is difficult to know what to do.
Disorganization with textbook reading requirements
The quiz and homework questions were not always the same as what we practiced in class. I sometimes felt I had to learn more to answer those questions correctly.
I felt that the class did not adequately prepare us for the first exam. The professor did not go over any expectations for the written / free-response portion of the exams at all in class, so seeing it on the exam felt paralyzing and I felt completely unprepared. I also felt that the canvas and syllabus for the class was lacking; the professor did not fix the canvas for us so that we could actually see our grades and only advised us not to trust the canvas and try to calculate our own grades on our own which would've been fine if he hadn't completely scrapped one part of the syllabus (pre-assignments).
I found the homeworks to be quite challenging. The difficulty of the homework was often significantly more than the rest of the course to the point that I had to rely on unlimited attempts to get a good grade. While I appreciate working through difficult problems, when the content is way above what we learn in class it makes it hard to learn anything from it.
Not a lot of test prep or reviews
A group project should be assigned at some point in the semester to increase engagement because the class is largely uninspiring homework assignments in RStudio. The content of the course would resonate with students if they were tasked to apply their learnings to an assignment with more depth than repetitive Canvas quizzes.
understanding lecture
This course was very challenging and there were not enough classes to understand the material fully.
more review materials/slides
The material itself was pretty challenging.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.